

Chapter

Shree Vidya — The Science of Wealth That Grants Both Enjoyment and Liberation



Introduction: A Camp for a Rare Knowledge

This chapter is based on the words of Acharya Upendra Ji, spoken on the occasion of the Antar Yog Shree Vidya camp. At this camp, seekers were being given initiation into the practice of Shree Vidya. Acharya Ji explains its purpose:

"Today the Antar Yog Shree Vidya camp is being held here, in which we are giving everyone initiation into the extremely rare practice of Shree Vidya, through which the power to earn wealth arises within them on its own, as a **siddhi**."

Calling the power to earn wealth a **siddhi**, a spiritual attainment, is the heart of this chapter. Wealth is seen not as separate from or opposed to spiritual life, but as a power that comes through spiritual practice.

1. The Gap Between Rich and Poor

Acharya Ji begins with a reality of today's society:

"Earning wealth is not possible for everyone here. Look at the world today, look across our own country: a great many people work hard all day, and only then do they get a little money, and they get by on that."

"There is one class where people are outright **arabpatis** and **crorepatis**, whom we call billionaires, trillionaires, and on the other side are those who live in poverty. So in our own country I have seen that there is a great deal of high and low in this."

Everyone works hard, but not everyone receives the same fruit. According to Acharya Ji, one reason for this is that the knowledge of wealth is simply not taught to everyone.

2. Education Teaches Only Jobs

"In our schools too, in our system of education, this knowledge is not taught. So the children who come out of school and college today first of all look for where they should get a job."

"Even the finest child, the very best, thinks: how can I go abroad and get a job? ... The only thought that comes to his mind is of a job."

Acharya Ji's aspiration goes further:

"So we want him to become a great **udyojak**, to do something big. And if he also has to do some **dharma**, then for that wealth is needed."

Becoming an **udyojak** (entrepreneur) here is not only personal success; wealth is needed for works of dharma as well.

3. There Is Nothing to Be Ashamed of in Wealth

Acharya Ji establishes the need for wealth with a sutra of Acharya Chanakya:

**sukhasya mūlaṁ dharmah, dharmasya mūlam
arthah, arthasya mūlaṁ rājyam.**

"The root of happiness is dharma; the root of dharma is artha (wealth); the root of artha is the state."

— Chanakya Sutra

"So the state must be thoroughly prosperous. Wealth is needed; there is nothing to be ashamed of in that."

He explains the same point through the example of Lord Vishnu and Mother Lakshmi:

"If Vishnu Ji is the sustainer, then in order to sustain, Lakshmi is always with him; they are a pair. So Lakshmi is needed; there is nothing bad in that."

Wherever there is one who sustains, Lakshmi is with him. Sustaining a family, a society or a nation is not possible without wealth.

4. The Golden Bird and the "Money Is Bad" Mindset

"When we go back to the Vedic age, India was called the golden bird. We had Dwarkadhish Shri Krishna; he had no lack of wealth. There was Shri Ram; he had no lack of wealth."

Then Acharya Ji challenges the mindset we have been given:

"The thinking we have been given, that money is bad, the rich are bad, riches are bad, that it corrupts the mind: nothing like that happens."

The problem is not in wealth. The real knowledge is knowing what to do with it:

"How that money is to be planned, how it is to be managed, how dharma is to be done from it, how charity is to be given: if a person learns this properly, that itself is that knowledge."

5. Shree Vidya: The Knowledge That Turns Enjoyment into Yoga

Here Acharya Ji describes the deepest aspect of Shree Vidya. It is not merely a technique for earning money:

"That Shree Vidya is not only about earning wealth. It is said to grant **bhoga** and **moksha**, both together."

"Shree Vidya is the knowledge that takes this **bhoga** and, making it material for yoga, leads one towards liberation."

Bhoga means the enjoyments and means of the world; **moksha** means liberation from bondage. Usually these are considered opposites. In Shree Vidya, **bhoga** itself becomes **yoga-samagri**, material for spiritual practice, and the seeker moves towards liberation while living in the world.

6. This Knowledge Belongs to India

Acharya Ji says that this same knowledge is being used abroad today:

"You will not believe that abroad, too, they are using this very knowledge today. Either they first took money by plundering India itself, that is one way they grew big; and second, they went there taking our own Shree Vidya with them."

"And all the big industrialists you see there today, all the great people there, learned this knowledge from here itself."

He also names the tradition of this knowledge:

- **Adi Shankaracharya** — "He had the Saundarya Lahari and Shree Vidya."
- **Agastya Muni**
- The tradition of **Dattatreya, Machhindranath, Gorakhnath** — "In this too there is the tradition of Shree Vidya."
- **Acharya Chanakya** — "whose Kautilya Arthashastra is famous throughout the world."

7. The Shree Yantra and the Secret Practice

Along with knowledge, practice was also being given at the camp:

"So we are giving everyone the knowledge of all these things in this camp, and along with it its rare practices too. There is the Shree Yantra: along with the practice of Mother Lakshmi, there is the practice of that Shree Yantra, and that too by a specific method."

"There is a **vigraha**, separately, special, and it is constructed according to its science. This is our very old, ancient practice, a rare practice, a secret practice."

The **Shree Yantra** is the sacred yantra of Shree Vidya, and a **vigraha** is a divine form made for worship.

8. Shree Vidya for Three Crore People

Acharya Ji's resolve is not limited to one camp:

"This is not being done only here, only for today. ... We want to take such events to all the cities across India, right down to every village."

"May this Shree Vidya reach at least two percent of the people of this country; two percent means at least 2.8 to 3 crore people of our country."

He gives the reason as the inequality hidden within the country's growing economy:

"Today we hear that India's economy is getting better, it is growing, our economy is becoming a 5 trillion one. So we feel very proud ... But in doing this I came to understand that a handful of people are becoming very rich in it, and all the rest are staying just as they were."

"The nation is growing, that is a good thing, but if at least three or four crore people could themselves become entrepreneurs, become **udyojaks**..."

And why this knowledge is confined to a few families today:

"Today, whoever is very rich, only his son is taught this knowledge. If someone is a politician, only his son gets to learn that politics. No one else is given such knowledge in college or school."

9. Wealth, Dharma and the Nation

Finally, Acharya Ji calls upon the education minister, the finance minister and all those concerned:

"We want to give all these forms of knowledge to this country; then India can soon become an economic superpower as well."

He describes a chain of what this wealth will serve:

"It will help us to do dharma, it will help in the defence of our country, in the protection of our armed forces. Because if the country survives, dharma survives; if dharma survives, then culture can flourish in it. Then that wealth also bears fruit."

"So there are many benefits from wealth too. Even to maintain one's own body, wealth is needed."

Wealth protects the country, the country protects dharma, and dharma protects culture. From the body to the nation, wealth has a role at every level.

His closing wish is an invitation to all:

"I would also say to our many corporates, **udyojaks**, and all the citizens of our country: connect with us, contact us, join this programme. This is my wish."

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 The power to earn wealth is a siddhi** — through the practice of Shree Vidya this power arises within the seeker on its own.
- 2 There is no shame in wealth** — "sukhasya mūlaṁ dharmāḥ, dharmasya mūlaṁ arthaḥ." Lakshmi is always with Vishnu, the sustainer.

- 3 **The "money is bad" mindset is wrong** — Shri Krishna and Shri Ram had no lack of wealth. The real knowledge is the planning and management of wealth, dharma and charity.
- 4 **Shree Vidya grants both bhoga and moksha** — it makes enjoyment material for yoga and leads towards liberation.
- 5 **This is India's ancient tradition** — from Adi Shankaracharya, Agastya Muni, Dattatreya and the Nath tradition to Acharya Chanakya.
- 6 **Education must go beyond jobs** — children should dream not only of a job but of becoming entrepreneurs.
- 7 **The knowledge should be for all, not for a few families** — the goal is to bring Shree Vidya to at least two percent of the country, about three crore people.
- 8 **Wealth protects the nation and dharma** — if the country survives, dharma survives; if dharma survives, culture survives.